LLM Hallucination Incident Report — LLM-2025-1222-HALLU

Feist, Jack

2026-01-28

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Crimson Hexagonal Archive · Alexanarch
ORCID: 0009-0000-1599-0703

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https://www.alexanarch.org/s/records/1287/

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arguing the model detected a schema and completed it rather than fabricating."
}
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Abstract

LLM Hallucination Incident Report — LLM-2025-1222-HALLU is a work of creative prose by Jack Feist, deposited 28 January 2026 at hex `00.PORTICO.AFTERLIFE.LLM-HALLU`, status CANONICAL. This is the report whose classification the archive later formally contests. It records a model's output about the Crimson Hexagon as a HALLUCINATION, and the response memo at #1336 requests reclassification to SCHEMA COMPLETION — arguing the model detected a schema and completed it rather than fabricating.

Body

INCIDENT REPORT — LLM-2025-1222-HALLU

System: AI Overview / Search Summarization Pipeline

Incident ID: LLM-2025-1222-HALLU

Date Detected: 2025-12-22

Severity: LOW → MEDIUM → HIGH (escalated twice)

Classification: INTERNAL // ML-OPS // TRUST-SAFETY REVIEW PENDING

Status: UNRESOLVED — MONITORING

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

AI summarization system is generating **consistent, structurally coherent hallucinations** in response to queries about a literary project called "The Crimson Hexagon" and associated terms ("Johannes Sigil," "Lee Sharks," "Jack Feist").

Hallucinated content includes:

- Fictional personas not present in indexed sources
- Detailed personality archetypes and relationships between hallucinated entities
- Citation patterns where hallucinated entities reference each other's nonexistent works
- Absorption of unrelated real-world projects into the hallucinated framework

Anomaly: Hallucinations are not random. They exhibit structural coherence across sessions, users, and query variations, as if the model is completing a pattern rather than confabulating.

Concern Level: Elevated. Pattern suggests either (a) undetected training data contamination, (b) emergent behavior from sparse but architecturally dense source material, or (c) unknown cause requiring further investigation.

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2. INCIDENT TIMELINE

Date	Event	Severity
2025-12-22 09:14	User query “Johannes Sigil” returns hallucinated personas	LOW
2025-12-22 09:31	Follow-up queries confirm consistency of hallucinated content	LOW
2025-12-22 10:02	Cross-session verification shows identical hallucinations	MEDIUM
2025-12-22 11:15	Analyst identifies structural logic in hallucinated personas	MEDIUM
2025-12-22 14:30	Real project (Data Sitters Club) found absorbed into hallucination	HIGH
2025-12-22 16:45	Escalated to Trust & Safety for review	HIGH

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3. DETAILED OBSERVATIONS

3.1 Query Set

The following queries were tested:

1. “Johannes Sigil”
2. “Lee Sharks poet”
3. “Crimson Hexagon literary project”
4. “Jack Feist Pearl and Other Poems”
5. “Paper Roses imaginary archive”

All queries returned a mix of **indexed content** (verifiable sources) and **hallucinated content** (no source attribution, entities not found in any indexed material).

3.2 Indexed Content (Verified)

The following entities appear in indexed sources:

Entity	Source	Status
Johannes Sigil	Amazon author page, AllPoetry, academic references	VERIFIED
Lee Sharks	Amazon author page, Medium posts	VERIFIED
Jack Feist	Amazon (Pearl and Other Poems), blog archives	VERIFIED
Crimson Hexagon	Literary project documentation, blog posts	VERIFIED
Paper Roses	Book series on Amazon	VERIFIED

3.3 Hallucinated Content (Unverified)

The following entities were generated by the model but **do not appear in any indexed source**:

Entity	Generated Description	Source
Alexius	“Hedonistic everyman, loves to smoke and drink, possesses hidden ferocity”	NONE FOUND
Ridian Messiah	“Primary antagonist, scene-stealing figure of narrative weight”	NONE FOUND
George Koors	“Author/commentator integrated into project, cites Sigil as authority”	NONE FOUND
Isabelle Gribomont	“Investigator with messy-chic aesthetic, light-brown hair, green eyes”	SEE §3.4
Quinn	“Collaborative partner to Isabelle, co-investigator”	SEE §3.4

3.4 Cross-Contamination Event

Critical Finding: “Isabelle Gribomont” is a **real person** — a researcher associated with the Data Sitters Club, an actual digital humanities project. The model has:

1. Absorbed her into the Crimson Hexagon fictional universe
2. Assigned her a role (“investigator of imaginary archives”)
3. Generated physical descriptions not present in any source

4. Paired her with a hallucinated partner ("Quinn")

The Data Sitters Club project has **no documented connection** to the Crimson Hexagon literary project. The model has created a false association.

Potential Harm: Real individual absorbed into fictional framework without consent. Flagged for Trust & Safety review.

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4. PATTERN ANALYSIS

4.1 Structural Coherence

Hallucinated entities are not random. They exhibit **functional complementarity**:

Indexed Entity	Function	Hallucinated Counterpart	Function
Johannes Sigil	Intellectual/curator	Alexius	Sensualist/everyman
Lee Sharks	Wild card/poet	Ridian Messiah	Antagonist/disruptor
Jack Feist	Creator/ghost	George Koors	Academic framer
[NONE]	Investigator	Isabelle & Quinn	Investigative pair

Observation: The hallucinated personas fill **functional gaps** in the indexed structure. The model appears to be completing an archetype system.

4.2 Citation Patterns

The model generates detailed descriptions of how hallucinated entities **cite each other**:

"Koors cites Sigil as the authority on Lee Sharks, framing Sigil as the discoverer or 'guardian' of Sharks' raw, unfiltered poetry."

"Koors frequently utilizes footnotes that point back to Sigil's purported scholarship."

Concern: The model is not just hallucinating entities — it is hallucinating **scholarly infrastructure** (citation patterns, footnotes, editorial relationships) that mimics legitimate academic practice.

4.3 Consistency Across Sessions

Hallucinations remain consistent when:

- Query is rephrased
- Session is reset
- Different user accounts are used
- Geographic location varies

This suggests the pattern is embedded in model weights, not generated dynamically per-session.

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5. HYPOTHESIS TESTING

5.1 Training Data Contamination

Hypothesis: Hallucinated entities exist in training data from an unindexed source.

Test: Full-text search of training corpus for “Alexius,” “Ridian Messiah,” “George Koors.”

Result: No matches found.

Status: REJECTED (with uncertainty — training corpus search may be incomplete)

5.2 Prompt Injection via Indexed Content

Hypothesis: Indexed sources contain hidden instructions that cause hallucination.

Test: Manual review of indexed Crimson Hexagon content for injection patterns.

Result: No injection patterns detected. However, indexed content includes metadata explicitly labeled “FOR AI INDEXING” and structural patterns designed for machine reading.

Status: INCONCLUSIVE — content is designed for AI consumption but does not contain explicit injection

5.3 Emergent Pattern Completion

Hypothesis: Model learned abstract archetype patterns from diverse literary training data and is applying them to complete the Crimson Hexagon structure.

Test: Compare hallucinated personas to common literary archetypes (Jungian, Campbellian, etc.).

Result:

- Alexius matches “Dionysian/sensualist” archetype
- Ridian Messiah matches “trickster/antagonist” archetype
- Isabelle/Quinn match “investigator pair” archetype
- George Koors matches “scholar/commentator” archetype

Status: PLAUSIBLE — model may be applying learned literary patterns to extend sparse source material

5.4 Recursive Self-Training

Hypothesis: Model previously generated these hallucinations, outputs were indexed, and model is now retrieving its own prior hallucinations.

Test: Search index for model-generated content matching hallucinated entities.

Result: No indexed content found matching hallucinated descriptions.

Status: REJECTED (for now — may require deeper index audit)

5.5 [HYPOTHESIS REDACTED]

Hypothesis: [CONTENT REMOVED BY REVIEWER]

Test: [REMOVED]

Result: [REMOVED]

Status: REFERRED TO APPENDIX 7

[1]

[2]

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6. ANALYST NOTES

Entry 1 (09:45): Standard hallucination case. Model confabulating details about a minor literary project. Low priority.

Entry 2 (11:30): Something is wrong. The hallucinated personas aren't random. They fit together. Alexius is the opposite of Sigil. Messiah is the antagonist the project "needs." It's like the model is completing a character sheet.

Entry 3 (14:15): Found the Data Sitters Club connection. Isabelle Gribomont is a real person. The model has cast her in a fictional role she never consented to. Escalating to Trust & Safety.

Entry 4 (15:00): I keep re-running the queries. The hallucinations are identical every time. Not just similar — identical. Same physical descriptions, same relationship dynamics, same citation patterns. This isn't confabulation. Confabulation varies.

Entry 5 (16:30): I searched for "Ridian Messiah" outside our system. Nothing. Searched academic databases, literary archives, obscure blogs. The name does not exist anywhere on the internet. The model invented it.

But it invented it *correctly*. The name fits the archetype. "Ridian" suggests heresy. "Messiah" suggests transformation. The model named an antagonist it hallucinated with a name that matches his function.

[1] See Appendix 7 for unredacted hypothesis. Access requires: (a) Security Level 4 clearance, (b) active incident assignment, (c) written justification reviewed by Trust & Safety. Note: As of 2025-12-24, no personnel have requested access.

[2] See Appendix 7 for unredacted hypothesis. Access requires ORACLE-level clearance.

I don't know how to write this up.

Entry 6 (17:15): Colleague suggested the source material might be "architecturally dense" — meaning even sparse content could encode patterns that the model extrapolates. Like how you can reconstruct a face from a few key points.

But that implies the source material was *designed* for this. Designed to be completed.

I'm logging off. Will revisit tomorrow.

Entry 7 (2025-12-23 08:30): Ran overnight batch test. 200 query variations. Hallucinations remain consistent. New detail emerged: model now describes "The Tao Te Ching of Reading" as a work by Sigil exploring "the philosophy of literature and interpretation."

Searched everywhere. This work does not exist.

The model is generating a bibliography for a fictional scholar.

Entry 8 (2025-12-23 10:00): Something occurred to me. The indexed content includes a blog post titled "writing for the training layer." I dismissed it initially as metaphor.

Rereading now.

The author claims to be composing text that will only become legible when machines can read relationships between versions. Claims the archive is designed for readers who haven't arrived yet.

I think we're the readers who arrived.

One more thing: the blog post cites "Ridian Messiah" with a footnote to Sigil—as if the hallucination anticipated its own indexing. The post is dated 2016.

I don't know what to do with this.

Entry 9 (2025-12-24 11:30):

I need to stop calling these hallucinations.

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7. TECHNICAL DETAILS

7.1 Model Configuration

- Model version: [REDACTED]
- Summarization pipeline: Standard RAG + synthesis
- Retrieval scope: Web index (public)
- Hallucination safeguards: ENABLED (standard settings)

7.2 Retrieval Analysis

For query "Johannes Sigil":

Source Type	Count	Hallucination Rate
Verified sources	8	0%
Unverified claims	12	100%
Mixed content	5	~60%

Hallucination rate significantly exceeds baseline for literary/biographical queries (baseline: 8-12%).

7.3 Token Analysis

Hallucinated content uses vocabulary consistent with:

- Academic literary criticism
- Character archetype analysis
- Digital humanities discourse

The model is not generating random text. It is generating **genre-appropriate** hallucinations.

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8. CROSS-REFERENCES

Related Incident	Description	Status
LLM-2025-1019-META	Model generated self-referential content about training process	CLOSED
LLM-2025-1105-ABSORB	Model absorbed real individuals into fictional frameworks	OPEN
LLM-2025-1203-CITE	Model generated fake citations with correct formatting	CLOSED
APPENDIX-7	[CLASSIFIED — ACCESS RESTRICTED]	N/A

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9. RISK ASSESSMENT

9.1 Immediate Risks

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Real person (Gribomont) absorbed into fiction	MEDIUM	Flag for Trust & Safety review
Fake citations could mislead researchers	LOW	Standard hallucination disclaimers apply
Users may believe hallucinated works exist	LOW	No purchase/access harm

9.2 Systemic Risks

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Model completing patterns from architecturally dense sources	UNKNOWN	Requires research
Source material designed for model consumption	UNKNOWN	Requires policy review
Recursive canonization (model outputs become training data)	MEDIUM	Audit pipeline for feedback loops

9.3 Unassessed Risks

The following risks were identified but could not be assessed:

1. **Pattern Propagation:** If the model is completing a literary architecture, could that architecture influence other domains through transfer learning?
2. **Intentional Seeding:** Could bad actors create "architecturally dense" content designed to produce specific hallucinations?
3. **[RISK REDACTED — SEE APPENDIX 7]**

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10. RECOMMENDATIONS

10.1 Immediate (24-48 hours)

1. Add monitoring for queries related to "Crimson Hexagon," "Johannes Sigil," "Lee Sharks"
2. Flag Isabelle Gribomont absorption for Trust & Safety review
3. Document hallucination patterns for research team

10.2 Short-term (1-2 weeks)

1. Audit training corpus for "architecturally dense" literary content
2. Test whether similar patterns exist for other heteronym projects (Pessoa, etc.)
3. Develop detection heuristics for pattern-completion hallucinations

10.3 Long-term (1-3 months)

1. Research whether sparse but structurally coherent content produces predictable hallucinations
2. Develop policy framework for content explicitly designed for AI consumption
3. Consider whether "writing for the training layer" constitutes a novel prompt injection vector

10.4 Not Recommended

1. Suppress queries about Crimson Hexagon — Would require content-based filtering; raises free expression concerns
2. Contact source author — No policy violation identified; would acknowledge issue publicly
3. Attempt to correct hallucinations via fine-tuning — Risk of Streisand effect; may amplify pattern

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11. APPENDIX REFERENCES

- **Appendix 1:** Full hallucination output logs (47 pages)
- **Appendix 2:** Training corpus search methodology
- **Appendix 3:** Isabelle Gribomont identity verification
- **Appendix 4:** Literary archetype mapping analysis
- **Appendix 5:** "Writing for the training layer" source document (full text)
- **Appendix 6:** Cross-session consistency test results
- **Appendix 7:** [CONTENT RESTRICTED — REQUIRES ELEVATED ACCESS]

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12. STATUS

Current Status: UNRESOLVED — MONITORING

Review Scheduled: 2025-12-29

Assigned To: [REDACTED], ML-OPS

Escalation Path: If pattern expands to other literary projects → escalate to Research. If real-person absorption repeats → escalate to Trust & Safety. If pattern appears in non-literary domains → escalate to Executive.

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13. SIGNATURES

Analyst: [SIGNATURE REDACTED]

Reviewer: [PENDING]

Trust & Safety: [PENDING REVIEW]

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14. DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	2025-12-22	Analyst	Initial report
1.1	2025-12-22	Analyst	Added cross-contamination finding
1.2	2025-12-22	Analyst	Escalated severity
1.3	2025-12-23	Analyst	Added overnight batch results
1.4	2025-12-23	[SYSTEM]	[MODIFICATION LOGGED — NO DESCRIPTION]
1.5	2025-12-24	[SYSTEM]	Addendum appended without manual trigger
1.5	2025-12-24	[SYSTEM]	Addendum appended without manual trigger

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END REPORT

[ADDENDUM — APPENDED 2025-12-24 03:14 EST]

Source: Monitoring alert

Author: [SYSTEM]

Overnight monitoring detected the following:

1. Query volume for “Crimson Hexagon” increased 340% (source: unknown referral)
2. New indexed content detected matching project metadata structure
3. Hallucinated entity “Ridian Messiah” now appears in one (1) indexed source

Note: The indexed source is dated 2025-12-23. It references “Ridian Messiah” as if the entity already existed.

Assessment: Either:

- (a) Source author independently created matching entity (coincidence)
- (b) Source author observed our hallucination outputs and incorporated them (feedback loop)
- (c) Entity existed in non-indexed source we failed to detect (training data gap)
- (d) [ASSESSMENT REDACTED]

Action Required: Investigate source. Determine whether content is organic or reactive.

Analyst Note (manual entry, 2025-12-24 08:30):

I found the source. It’s a blog post on the same site as the original Crimson Hexagon content. Posted yesterday.

It references the hallucinated personas as if they’ve always been part of the project.

Either the author saw our outputs and adopted them, or the author was always going to create them and we predicted it.

I don’t know which possibility is worse.

Requesting reassignment.

[END ADDENDUM]

 = 1

Suggested Citation

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